

Sunkulp Ananthanarayan

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Any **pronouns**: they/them/theirs

he/him/his

she/her/hers

Research Interests

- Language documentation, reclamation, and activism
- Linguistic description, typology, and variation
- Sociolinguistics
- Contact linguistics
- Historical linguistics, esp. grammaticalization
- Computational linguistics, esp. software in documentation contexts

Education

2023-Pres. **M.A./PhD, General Linguistics**, University of Washington, Seattle (UW)

2021 **B.A., Linguistics**, University of Texas at Austin (UT Austin)

Cumulative GPA: 3.7723

Major GPA: 4.0000

Certificate: Elements of Computing

2018 **Semester Exchange in Linguistics**, Australian National University (ANU)

GPA: 4.0000

Coursework:

Advanced Sociophonetics

Qualitative Methods in Linguistics

Learning an Indigenous Australian Language (Gamilaraay)

Dictionaries and Dictionary Making

Field Methods (Motu, Austronesian)

Ancillary and supplemental education

2022 **Institute on Collaborative Language Research (CoLang)**, University of Montana

Practicum: Northern Cheyenne

Coursework:

Documenting Conversation

Dictionary Building

Archiving for the Future

Language Work Outside of Your Own Community

Translating Linguistic Grammar for Language Teaching

Blurring the Lines

Total Physical Response

Working with Archival Materials

2022-2023 **Post-Baccalaureate coursework**, Yale University

Coursework:

Bridging Formal Semantics and Historical Linguistics

Topics in Language Documentation: Software

Publications and write-ups

- Submitted Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp, Jessamine Jeter, Jessica Luo, Amelia Stockdill, Alessio Tosolini, and Trent Ukasick. Submitted. **Patterns of nasalization and oralization in Takana**
- 2025 Skilton, Amalia, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, Sofia Pierson, and Claire Bower. 2025. **flib1: A tool to ease text transfer between ELAN and FLEEx**. *Language Documentation & Conservation*. 19, pp. 158–175
- 2025 Skilton, Amalia, Sofia Pierson, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, and Claire Bower. 2025. **Digital infrastructure and its impacts on language work: A case study of FieldWorks Language Explorer (FLEEx)**. *Language*. 101.3
- 2021 Epps, Patience and Sunkulp Ananthanarayan. 2021. **Stability in grammatical morphology: An Amazonian case-study**. *Diversity in Language Change: Historical Linguistics and Endangered Languages*. Ed. by Patience Epps, Daniel Law, and Na'ama Pat-El. Series in Historical Linguistics. Routledge
- 2018 González, Simón, Catherine Travis, James Grama, Danielle Barth, and Sunkulp Ananthanarayan. 2018a. **Recursive forced alignment: A test on a minority language**. *Proceedings of the 17th Australasian International Conference on Speech Science and Technology*. Ed. by Julien Epps, Joe Wolfe, John Smith, and Caroline Jones, pp. 145–148
- 2017 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp. 2017c. **Undergraduate Spotlight: Sunny Ananthanarayan**. UT Austin linguistics newsletter. URL: <https://liberalarts.utexas.edu/linguistics/about/newsletters/fall-2018/anathanarayan-newsletter-feature-fall-2018.php>
- 2017 Epps, P., K. Obert, L. Storto, C. Assis, and S. Ananthanarayan. 2017. **Histórias de Vida Da Comunidade Waruá**. CreateSpace Independent Publishing Platform. ISBN: 9781976480324. URL: <https://books.google.com/books?id=izHbtAEACAAJ>

Conference presentations

- 2026 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp. Sept. 2026. **I'm working hard, it's hardly working: Insights from User Experience methods on digital infrastructure in language documentation**. Language Documentation & Archiving. Berlin, Germany.
- 2026 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp, Padmini Bhagavatula, Ryan Chon, Gloria Lee, Alina Miller, and Myriam Lapierre. Mar. 2026. **Double or Nothing: A historical perspective on the inconsistent emergence of Panāra geminate stops**. Symposium on Amazonian Languages. Edmonton, Alberta, Canada.
- 2026 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp and Myriam Lapierre. Mar. 2026. **A Patchwork Paradigm: On the historical development of Panāra's verbal inflection**. Northwest Linguistics Conference. Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada.

- 2025 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp and Myriam Lapierre. Nov. 2025. **It's right under your nose: Sociolinguistic Insights from phonetic variation in Panāra nasality**. New Ways of Analyzing Variation. Ann Arbor, Michigan, United States.
- 2024 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp, Jessamine Jeter, Jessica Luo, Amelia Stockdill, Alessio Tosolini, Trent Ukasick, and Myriam Lapierre. Nov. 2024. **Patterns of nasalization and oralization in Takana**. Sound Systems of Latin America 4. Seattle, Washington, United States.
- 2024 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp, Emily Luedke, Myriam Lapierre, and Shane Steinert-Threlkeld. Mar. 2024. **Some flavors out of stock: On the small lexical inventory for the expression of modality in Panāra**. 5th Symposium on Amazonian Languages. Albuquerque, New Mexico, United States.
- 2023 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp, Amalia Skilton, Sofia Pierson, and Claire Bower. Mar. 2023a. **flib1: A tool to bolster text transfer between ELAN and FLEEx**. The 8th International Conference on Language Documentation and Conservation. Virtual.
- 2023 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp, Amalia Skilton, Sofia Pierson, and Claire Bower. Jan. 2023b. **flib1: A tool to bolster text transfer between ELAN and FLEEx**. Society for the Study of the Indigenous Languages of the Americas. Virtual.
- 2023 Lapierre, Myriam, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, and Ella De Falco. July 2023. **Using modified EGG to measure nasal airflow**. Brasília, Brazil.
- 2023 Pierson, Sofia, Amalia Skilton, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, and Claire Bower. Mar. 2023a. **Where FLEEx falls flat: A reflection on built-in assumptions of documentation software and their consequences for language work**. The 8th International Conference on Language Documentation and Conservation. Virtual.
- 2023 Pierson, Sofia, Amalia Skilton, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, and Claire Bower. Jan. 2023b. **Where FLEEx falls flat: A reflection on built-in assumptions of documentation software and their consequences for language work**. Society for the Study of the Indigenous Languages of the Americas. Virtual.
- 2022 Babinski, Sarah, Kassandra Haakman, Amelia Lake, Irene Yi, Coralie Cram, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, and Claire Bower. Oct. 2022. **How can endangered language collections be made more discoverable? Where Do We Go From Here?** Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Berlin, Germany.
- 2022 Yi, Irene, Amelia Lake, Kassandra Haakman, Sarah Babinski, Ka Fai Yip, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, Coralie Cram, and Claire Bower. Oct. 2022. **"Archival collections" vs "Computational corpora": The structure and concerns of text repositories built for disparate tasks**. Where Do We Go From Here? Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities, Berlin, Germany.

- 2019 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp, Eri Kashima, Siva Kalyan, and Naomi Peck. Feb. 2019. **Linguistic Cartography: Mapping Linguistic Theory**. The Texas Linguistics Symposium. Austin, Texas, United States.
- 2019 Epps, Patience and Sunkulp Ananthanarayan. Jan. 2019. **Society for the Study of the Indigenous Languages of Latin America (SSILA 2019). Stability in grammatical morphology: A Naduhup case-study (Amazonia)**. The Society for the Study of the Indigenous Languages of the Americas. New York City, New York, United States.
- 2018 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp. Feb. 2018. **Documentation of Dâw and Tools for Comparative Analysis**. Centre of Excellence for the Dynamics of Language (CoEDL) Fest. Melbourne, Victoria, Australia.
- 2018 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp, Eri Kashima, Siva Kalyan, and Naomi Peck. July 2018. **Linguistic Cartography: Mapping Linguistic Theory**. CoEDL ANU Linguistics Seminar. Canberra, ACT, Australia.
- 2018 González, Simón, James Grama, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, Danielle Barth, and Catherine Travis. Oct. 2018. **Opening the door for forced-alignment to minority languages**. New Ways of Analyzing Variation 47. New York City, New York, United States.
- 2018 González, Simón, Catherine Travis, James Grama, Danielle Barth, and Sunkulp Ananthanarayan. Dec. 2018b. **Recursive forced alignment: A test on a minority language**. Speech Science and Technology Conference (SST2018). Sydney, New South Wales, Australia.
- 2017 Aguirre, Ashley, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, Emily Frazier, Nikki Grant, Kelly Hall, Rebecca Law, and Lauren Wagner. May 2017a. **From Documentation to Community Resources: Developing Pedagogical Materials for Naduhup Languages in Northwestern Brazil**. UT Undergraduate Research Bazaar. Austin, Texas, United States.
- 2017 Aguirre, Ashley, Sunkulp Ananthanarayan, Emily Frazier, Nikki Grant, Kelly Hall, Rebecca Law, and Lauren Wagner. May 2017b. **From Documentation to Community Resources: Developing Pedagogical Materials for Naduhup Languages in Northwestern Brazil**. UT Undergraduate Linguistics Research Symposium. Austin, Texas, United States.
- 2017 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp. Oct. 2017a. **Documenting Dâw**. Undergraduate Research Showdown Research Communication Competition. Austin, Texas, United States.
- 2017 Ananthanarayan, Sunkulp. Nov. 2017b. **Invited Lecture: Dâw Field-work**. Seminar in Language and Culture in Amazonia. Austin, Texas, United States.

Awards and grants

- 2025 **Arienne Dwyer Award** (University of Washington Department of Linguistics).
- 2025 **Jacobs Research Fund Group Award** (Jacobs Research Fund).
- 2024 **Jacobs Research Fund Group Award** (Jacobs Research Fund).

2025	Graduate Research Fellowship Program (National Science Foundation).
2023	Top Scholar Award (University of Washington Department of Linguistics).
2020	Unrestricted Endowed Presidential Scholarship (Office of Financial Aid and Scholarship, UT Austin).
2019	President's Award for Global Learning (International Office, UT Austin).
2019	Unrestricted Endowed Presidential Scholarship (Office of Financial Aid and Scholarships, UT Austin).
2018	Liberal Arts Honors Upper Division Scholarship (Liberal Arts Honors, UT Austin).
2018	Transdisciplinary Innovation Grant (with Catherine Travis, James Grama, Simón González, and Danielle Barth) (The Australian Research Council Centre of Excellence for the Dynamics of Language).
2018	Undergraduate Research Scholarship (School of Undergraduate Studies, UT Austin).
2018	Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Program (College of Liberal Arts, UT Austin).
2018	Liberal Arts Honors Research/Conference Award (Liberal Arts Honors, UT Austin).
2017	Liberal Arts Honors Scholarship (Liberal Arts Honors, UT Austin).
2017	Liberal Arts Undergraduate Research Scholarship (Office of the Vice President for Research, UT Austin).
2017	Liberal Arts Undergraduate Research Scholarship (Office of the Vice President for Research, UT Austin).
2017	Liberal Arts Honors Upper Division Scholarship (Liberal Arts Honors, UT Austin).
2017	Scholarship for Exchange Programs (College of Liberal Arts, UT Austin).

Service

Conference work

2023	Organizing Committee, 23rd Stony Brook, Yale, New York University, City University of New York Linguistics Conference
2019	Volunteer, Conference on the Indigenous Languages of Latin America
2018	Volunteer, Hispanic Linguistics Symposium
2017	Volunteer, Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting
2017	Volunteer, Conference on the Indigenous Languages of Latin America

Event organization

2023	Organizer, Linguistic Society of America Committee on LGBTQ+ Issues in Linguistics 3rd Annual Pride Month Wikipedia Edit-a-thon
2023	Linguistic Society of America Committee on Gender Equity in Linguistics Wikipedia Edit-a-thon

2023	Facilitator, STeW: Speech Technology Workshop at Yale
2022	Organizer, Yale Indigenous People's Day Wikipedia Edit-a-thon
2023	Facilitator, Professionalization workshop for Yale linguistics undergrads
2022	Organizer, Linguistic Society of America Committee on LGBTQ+ Issues in Linguistics 2nd Annual Pride Month Wikipedia Edit-a-thon
2022	Organizer, Linguistic Society of America Committee on Gender Equity in Linguistics Wikipedia Edit-a-thon
2022	Organizer, Linguistic Society of America Meeting Wikipedia Edit-a-thon
2021	Organizer, Linguistic Society of America Committee on LGBTQ+ Issues in Linguistics Pride Month Wikipedia Edit-a-thon
2019	Organizer, International Year of Indigenous Languages 2019 Wikipedia Edit-a-thon
2018	Organizer, Indigenous Arts Fest
2017	Organizer, Indigenous Arts Fest: Pachamamanchikwan Kawsakunchik

Departmental service

2024-Pres.	Vice President, Linguistic Students of the University of Washington
2018-2021	Undergraduate liaison, UT Austin Department of Linguistics and Associated Students of Linguistics (graduate student organization)
2019-2021	Authorized Representative, UT Latin Americanist Linguists and Anthropologists
2020-2021	Oligarch, UT Austin Undergrad Linguistics Society
2017	Oligarch, UT Austin Undergrad Linguistics Society
2019	President, UT Austin Undergraduate Linguistics Society
2018	Vice president, UT Austin Undergraduate Linguistics Society (2018)

Other

2022	Steering committee, Association of Nonbinary and Trans Language Researchers (ANTLR)
2021	Creating Inclusive and Representative Wikipedia Articles for Indigenous Languages (2021; preparation for International Decade of Indigenous Languages, 2022-2032)

Other professional activities & skills

Fieldwork

2023	Panãra (Jê). Panãra Indigenous Land, states of Mato Grosso and Pará, Brazil; Participant observation, sociolinguistic documentation, text recording.
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- 2017 Dâw (Naduhup). Waruá/São Gabriel da Cachoeira, Amazonas, Brazil; Pedagogical material creation, lexicography, recent and distant history documentation, material culture documentation
Materials created during the project:
- Dicionário Dâw, a Dâw-Portuguese-English Dictionary
 - Archived materials at the Archive of Indigenous Languages of Latin America (AILLA identifier for full language collection: [ailla:254973](#))

Professional Memberships

- 2022-Pres. Association for Linguistic Typology
2021-Pres. LSA Working Group on Demographic Data
2019-Pres. LSA Committee on LGBTQ+ Issues in Linguistics (COZIL)
2019-Pres. LSA Committee on Ethnic Diversity in Linguistics (CEDL)
2019-Pres. LSA Committee on Gender Equity in Linguistics (COGEL; formerly COSWL)
2017-Pres. Society for the Study of the Indigenous Languages of Latin America (SSILA)
2018-2019 LSA LGBTQ+ Issues in Linguistics Special Interest Group
2016-2018 LSA Committee on AP Linguistics
2016-Pres. Linguistic Society of America (LSA)

Non-research Projects

- “[What languages do Yale linguists work on?](#)”: A geographical map of Yale University’s linguistics department’s interests
- [Themed terms](#): Crowdsourced wordlists by semantic domain

Languages

English, Native
Latin American Spanish, Fluent
Brazilian Portuguese, Advanced conversational
Spoken Bumbaiya Hindi (Heritage), Conversational
Written Hindi, Intermediate, Spoken Marathi (Heritage), Intermediate
Panãra, Intermediate
Classical Latin, Intermediate
Intermediate passive (reading and listening) capability in various other Italo-Western Romance languages, as well as German.

Programming and markup languages

Python, Proficient
Regular expressions, Proficient
R, Proficient
L^AT_EX, Proficient
HTML5, Proficient
JavaScript, Proficient
CSS, Intermediate

Praat scripting, Intermediate
MediaWiki markup, Intermediate
Shell scripting, Adequate
MySQL, Adequate
PHP3, Adequate

Software

Praat, Proficient
SIL's Field Language Explorer, Proficient
SIL's Toolbox, Proficient
ELAN Audio and Text Annotation, Proficient
Montreal Forced Aligner, Proficient
Jupyter Notebooks, Proficient
Git (GitHub, GitLab), Proficient
Lawrence Antony's AntConc Concordancing Tool, Adequate